

PermitRootLogin no

Now, the only way to get root privileges is through *su* (i.e., only after logging in as a normal user remotely), which means crackers now need to break two passwords to get full access.

While you are editing that file, find the line that says:

Protocol 2, 1

Change it to:

Protocol 2

This will remove the option to fall back to the original SSH protocol that's now considered very vulnerable.

—Ajeet Singh Raina, ajeetraina@gmail.com

Duplicate a hard disk

Well, there are times when you'd certainly need to copy the contents of one hard disk to another. This is how you can do it, using the *dd* command as the root user:

```
# dd if=/dev/sda of=/dev/sdb
```

...where, *if=/dev/sda* is the input disk (or source), and *of=/dev/sdb* is the output disk (or destination).

A word of caution: Be very careful while using the *dd* command—because if you aren't, you might end up wiping your hard disk clean.

—Gaurav, opensrc24@gmail.com

Knowing who's using which port

Linux contains a lot of command-line tools that make the job of a network administrator easier. One of them is *netstat*, a multi-purpose network information tool. Using *netstat*, you can find out which ports are being used by various processes or users, as follows:

```
# netstat -an | more
```

For example, if I wanted to verify who owns the telnet port, then I'd run the following code:

```
# netstat -nap | grep :23
```

There is a utility called *fuser* that also tells you which user and process owns a port:

```
# fuser -v -n tcp 23
```

—Gaurav, opensrc24@gmail.com

You've got mail

Ever wondered if there's a quick way to send mails to someone working on another terminal on the same machine? Well, the steps are quite simple.

Install the packages *mailx* and *mailutils*, if they're not already installed, to get started. The following command (which is available in all GNU/Linux systems) will give you the list of users who are currently logged in to the system:

```
$ who
```

Let's suppose there is a user on terminal *tty2* called *amit* and you'd like to mail him. Run the following command:

```
$ mail amit
```

...after which the following text will appear:

```
subject:
```

Key in the subject of the mail, press *Enter* and then type your message. Once done, press *Ctrl+d*. This will show the following code:

```
Cc:
```

Add the user names of those to whom you want to send a cc, otherwise just press *Enter*.

Now 'amit' can check his mail by running the following:

```
$ mail
```

This opens up Amit's inbox. After reading your message, he can delete it by typing *d*, or reply by typing *r*.

—Amit Kumar, amit.hak50@gmail.com

END 

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